

# Course milestone M17: Release Audit, Final Research Chapter, and AI-Management Portfolio

## HONR 46400 · Evidence-Driven Research

### What to submit

One document, `lastname_m17.pdf`. Everything this milestone asks for goes inside it, as sections in the order below. One artifact travels beside it, because it cannot live inside a PDF:

Submit it on Brightspace, under **Assignments** then **M17**. Brightspace carries the deadline.

This milestone presents **Book Milestone 12: Your release and next cycle** (checkpoint, version 1) of the course book, EDR|AI.

- `lastname_m17_chapter.ipynb`: The runnable notebook behind the chapter must pass restart-and-run-all and be executed by the grader, so it cannot be folded into the PDF.

### What this course adds

#### Defend your work out loud

Your **Evidence Defense** is performed live in class and graded in the room. It is never a file you upload.

1. You defend once, in the slot you are assigned. Rounds run in the Wednesday defense blocks of the last two weeks, and the final round runs in the last Friday studio.
2. A full slot gives you ten minutes to defend plus five minutes of cross-examination. A compressed round keeps the same order and the same proportions, and the defense schedule gives your exact length.
3. Use three movements, in this order. **Claims** (about three minutes): your headline claim and the exact edge it stops at. **Choices** (about four minutes): why this compass position, this data strategy, this measurement, and the road you did not take. **Verification** (about three minutes): how you checked, what survived, which sources you confirmed real, and how your release audit came out.
4. Bring your full claim ledger with your three weakest rows already marked, plus your dossier draft and your package, ready to open live if someone probes.
5. Where your ledger says a claim reaches too far, concede precisely and name the smaller true claim. A well-timed concession is scored as strength.
6. Three moves are forbidden: inventing a new claim under pressure, taking a concession back by insisting rather than by evidence, and blaming the AI tool.

If a defense falls apart, it converts to a supported walkthrough and you may elect a redo slot later in the sequence. That is not a zero.

#### Cross-examine your classmates

On every day you are not defending, ask the defenders at least one question. Ground it in a ledger row, a decision, or a verification step. Probe hard, stay respectful, and never make it personal. Your questioning is scored, so silence costs you.

#### Close the dossier in the final studio

The last Friday studio runs a final dossier checklist against your draft. Work through it in the room and close every open item, or write the reason it stays open, before you upload. Arrive with the work complete enough to submit at the start of that session rather than at the end.

## What your submission contains

1. One PDF carries the whole milestone: your final research chapter, then your release audit with its decision, your dossier manifest, and your AI-management portfolio, each as a clearly marked section.
2. Upload the runnable notebook behind the chapter as well. It must pass restart-and-run-all, and every headline number in the chapter must rerun from it with no manual steps.
3. The portfolio section is always yours alone, written from your own full-semester ledger, even if your project is shared.

## If your project is an approved group

Share the chapter and the notebook, and name every member on both. Write your own portfolio and give your own defense. Those two are scored per person, so members can finish with different scores.

## This milestone is terminal

There is no revision window and no resubmission. The deadline governs the grade, so assemble everything before you upload.

## How it is judged

The Book Milestone rubric that follows scores the milestone artifact. Separately, your chapter, your portfolio, and your live defense are each scored and then combined into the Instructor/TA Evaluation part of your Final Project grade. Four failures cap their own rubric row at the lowest band, however strong the rest is: a source that does not exist or does not say what you claim, a number or figure with no path back to your data, a headline number that does not rerun, and a release claimed while your run is stale or an audit row is blocking. Withholding honestly, with the repair named, never triggers that last one. A missing AI Research Ledger leaves your portfolio ungraded until you supply it.

## Milestone 12: Your release and next cycle

### Open the milestone workbook in Colab

**This chapter closes Studio 12: Special topic: agentic AI, release, and the next cycle.** Its lessons each ended at **It is your turn**; what you wrote there arrives here as working material, and this is where the pieces become one artifact you can defend.

**What this milestone produces.** A review-management record for your directed AI team, a release audit recording release or withhold-pending-a-named-repair, your final dossier with a complete manifest, an explicit stopping rule, and your next-study agenda.

## What you bring

You also carry forward the last milestone's artifact: **Milestone 11: Your reproducible package**. This one builds on it, and the chain assumes it is versioned and filed.

Check you are carrying each of these before you start. If one is missing, go back and work that lesson's **It is your turn** first; the practice below assumes it.

- Lesson 38: Managing Multiple AI Agents: your closing-review team: the loops' scoped jobs, the dependency wiring and turn counts, and the one node you kept human.
- Lesson 39: Conflicting Agents and Human Escalation: your escalation rules, and one load-bearing pair of outputs (agreeing or not) diagnosed and settled by your own check, with any override on record.
- Lesson 40: Final Research and AI-Management Portfolio: your finished research artifact with every claim bounded, your AI-management portfolio with the team record inside, and the rehearsed three-movement defense.

## The practice

1. Check that nothing moved since your Studio 11 cold run: any change to the package (a number, a claim, the data, the code, the environment record, or the instructions a stranger would follow) makes that run stale. Repeat it before you release.
2. Run the closing review as a directed team: scoped loops (a writer, a skeptic, an auditor at minimum), wired so each role's input exists before it starts, escalation rules written first, one node kept human. Declare who chooses each next step: you, a fixed script, or an agent that plans and calls tools, and never call a manually sequenced chat autonomous. A single well-run assistant playing the roles in turn is a legal team; record what you actually ran, never invented activity.

3. Run the release audit and mark each item clear, pending, or blocking: permissions, participant promises, disclosure, package-matches-cold-run, reproducibility, claim boundaries, and uncertainty.
4. Make the release decision. A blocking item means withhold pending the named repair, written as this version's reason, not a euphemistic release.
5. Assemble the dossier with a manifest: contract versions, evidence registry, permissions, measurement, analysis and claim ledgers, AI ledger, artifacts, package, and revision history: each marked present, absent with reason, or not applicable.
6. Write your stopping rule: why you are stopping here rather than running one more check, stated as a decision.
7. Write the next-study agenda: tie the next question to an unresolved limitation, a warrant gap, or something this cycle's evidence opened.

## A version, not a pass

Your milestone artifact is a dated, numbered **version** with the reason for the version attached. When later evidence changes it, you write the next version rather than editing the last one, because the sequence of changes is itself part of your research record.

## The four rails, here

Four concerns cross every studio in this book. At this milestone they take these specific forms.

- **Ethics, permissions, and data exposure.** Release is the last point at which a permission problem can still be prevented.
- **Evidence, provenance, and reproducibility.** The dossier is the evidence rail made assemblable.
- **AI activity, verification, and human decisions.** This studio is the ledger's graduation: loop wiring, conflicts, overrides, and independence checks all land as rows before it closes; record the team you actually ran.
- **Uncertainty, claim boundary, and revision history.** State what you still do not know as clearly as what you found.

## Where this milestone sits

You arrived carrying Milestone 11: Your reproducible package. This is where the chain closes, on a decision. If the audit clears, the artifact leaves your hands; if it does not, this version names the repair that still blocks release. Either way the next-study agenda opens the cycle that follows.

## What sends you back

The next-study agenda is the revisit; a research cycle ends by declaring the next one.

## How this milestone is assessed

Each row scores **0, 1, or 2. 10 points total.**

| # | Criterion                                                                 | 0                                                                   | 1                                                                              | 2                                                                       |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The milestone artifact exists in full, specific to your own project       | absent, or generic text that would fit any project                  | present but incomplete, or specific in some parts and generic in others        | complete and unmistakably about your project                            |
| 2 | The milestone is written as a dated, numbered version with its reason     | no version, or a version with no reason given                       | versioned, but the reason is decorative rather than an account of what changed | versioned with a reason a reader could use to reconstruct your thinking |
| 3 | Every judgment in the artifact is defended by you, not asserted by a tool | conclusions appear with no reasoning, or reproduce a tool's wording | reasoning present but thin where the decision was hardest                      | each judgment carries a reason you could defend under questioning       |
| 4 | The four rails are carried in the form this studio requires               | one or more rails absent where this studio required them            | all rails present but one is nominal                                           | every rail addressed in the form this studio requires                   |
| 5 | The milestone's own product is present and                                | release claimed despite a stale cold run or a                       | components present, but one audit disposition is                               | every disposition is traceable, blocking items                          |

| # | Criterion                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 0                                                                     | 1                                        | 2                                                                                                                                        |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | defensible: A review-management record for your directed AI team, a release audit recording release or withhold-pending-a-named-repair, your final dossier with a complete manifest, an explicit stopping rule, and your next-study agenda | blocking item, or the dossier manifest or next-study agenda is absent | unsupported or the next study is generic | are honored, the manifest is complete or explicitly accounts for absences, and the next study follows from a documented unresolved issue |

### ! Blocking gate

No work at or after Studio 4 proceeds past a not-authorized determination. This is not scored and cannot be averaged away.

### ! Blocking gate

Release requires the package to match its Studio 11 cold run; any change since that run means withhold pending a repeat. This is not scored and cannot be averaged away.

## Your workbook

Open the workbook with the link above. It walks these steps with a cell for each one, ends by writing your milestone version with its reason, and adds the rows this studio contributes to your AI Research Ledger and your Research Dossier.